

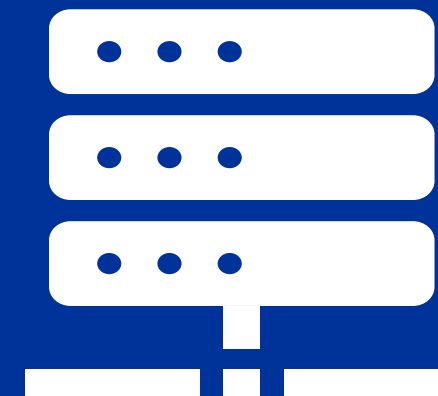
REPUBLIC OF CONGO

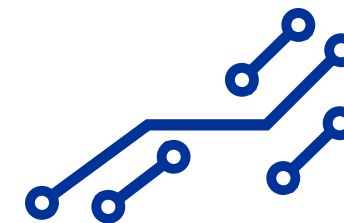
DATA CENTER MARKET BRIEFING

A strategic overview of the data center investment opportunity in the Republic of Congo

A Xalam Analytics Country Report

January 2026



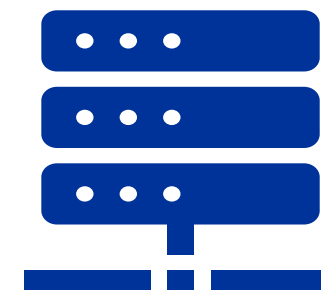


This report is part of a series of market briefs developed by Xalam Analytics at the behest of Digital Investment Facility (DIF) under the Data Governance in Africa Initiative, on the data center market opportunity in sub-Saharan Africa (“SSA”). This analysis aims to provide key insights into market demand and supply patterns for data center markets, business landscape, regulatory impact and investment returns. The research aims to provide potential investors and stakeholders with the latest information on the data center market in the SSA region.

This country review is based on our assessment of information and data as available to our research. It is further underpinned by our understanding of the marketplace along with market data and insights collected through continuous research. The numbers and estimates in this report are derived from a mix of sources, including estimates from Xalam Analytics’ economic models, data providers, regulator data and other sources as may be indicated.

This report is prepared with funds from the [Data Governance in Africa Initiative](#), a project financed by the European Union, Germany, Belgium, Estonia, Finland and France under the [Digital for Development \(D4D\) Hub](#). Its contents are the sole responsibility of Xalam Analytics and do not necessarily reflect the views of the funders.

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The Congo data center investment case

One of Africa's smallest economies is taking proactive steps to accelerate Internet adoption and digital transformation



THE OPPORTUNITY

- Early-stage status leaves room for **potentially robust long-term growth** as demand accelerates.
- **Accelerated government initiatives** to digitize public services.
- Relatively dynamic telecoms market suggests underlying potential; Congo's broadband base and Internet traffic look set to double by 2030.
- **Deeper fiber infrastructure:** arrival of 2Africa cable, ongoing Central African Backbone (CAB) project to expand Congo's terrestrial fiber reach, connecting to secondary towns and neighboring countries.
- **Expanded initiatives and projects** to triple power generation capacity.
- Increased flexibility in power sector to encourage deployment of renewable sources of power.

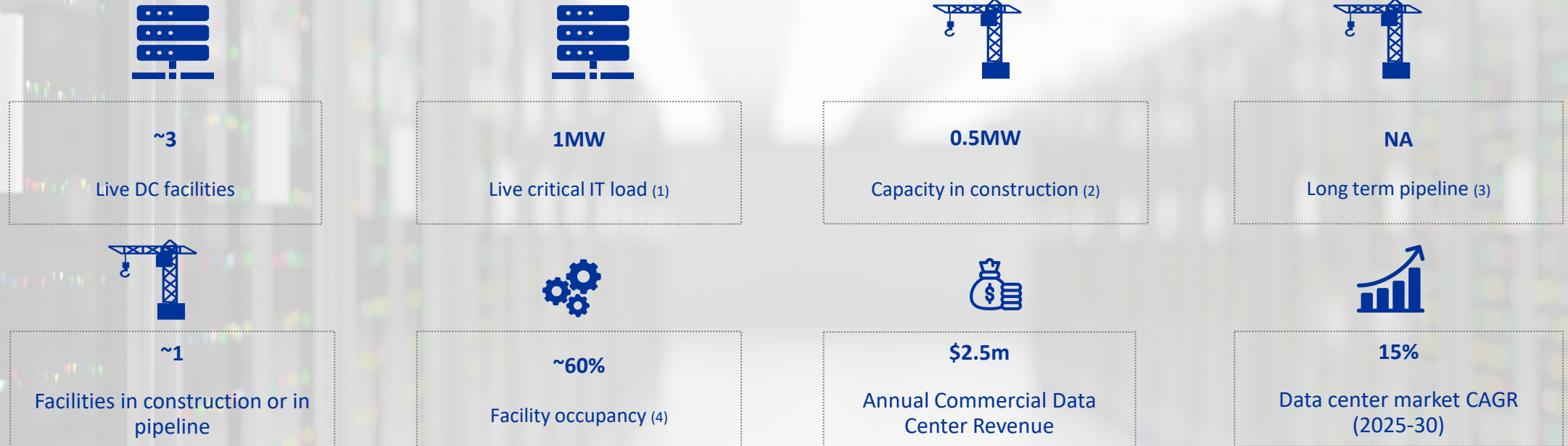


CHALLENGES & RISKS

- **Small-scale demand potential**, very early phases of migration to cloud, colocation services.
- **Intermittently challenging economic conditions** putting pressure on demand; ~1%-3% GDP growth in recent years.
- **Power capacity, reliability** are still well-below demand requirements.
- Renewable presence in Congo's power mix is still small.
- Relatively limited fiber diversity.

Congo data center market overview

Estimates as of 2025



(1) Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease by third-party customers.

(2) IT load capacity from facilities currently in construction; construction has broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases are in progress.

(3) Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land control, energy supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken. Capacity expected to be available by the end of 2030.

(4) Percent of available capacity that is effectively being used by third party customers.

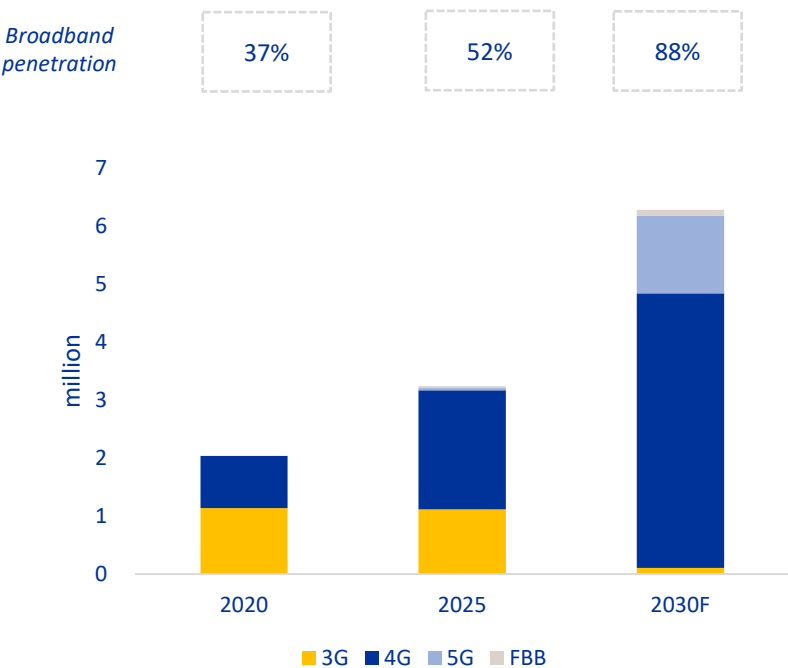
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Key drivers of demand for data centers

Building digital infrastructure to support a fast-growing digital base and boost economic development

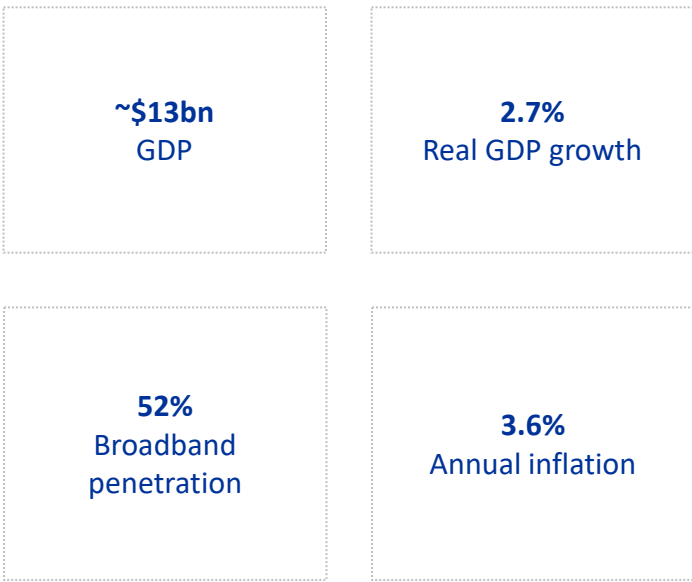
A growing digital customer base

Congo broadband connections by type - million



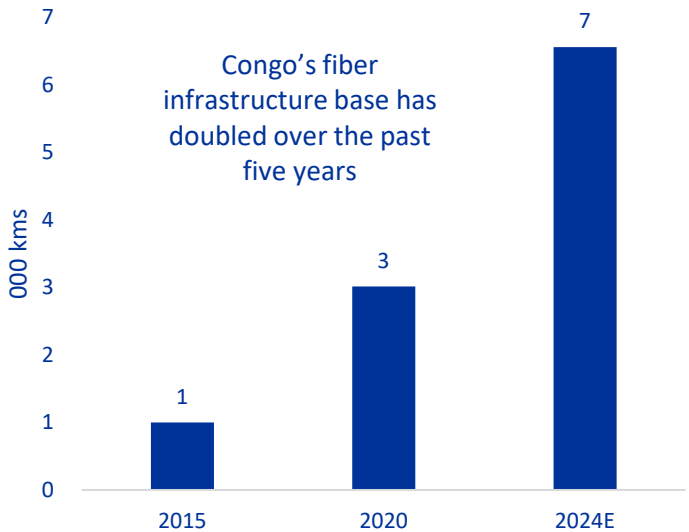
Stable economic growth, despite increasingly challenging macro

Sample Congo economic indicators - 2025



Accelerated digital infrastructure build

Congo terrestrial fiber – 000 kms



Sources: IMF, ARPCE and provider data, Xalam Analytics estimates

Data center market conditions

Congo's data center operating environment has long been highly constrained; it is now gradually improving, though pressures remain

Data privacy, hosting & environmental regulations



- Congo passed a data privacy law in 2019;
- The establishment of a data commission was approved in 2024.
- A swath of other laws to refine the regulatory framework, including a law defining the framework for digital startups, and a cybersecurity law.

Electricity market



- Congo generates 0.5GW of grid power annually, from a single power plant located in Pointe Noire.
- Power generation is primarily based on natural gas; annual production closer to 300MW, well below demand.
- Electricity prices are relatively moderate, at \$0.10 per kWh.
- Renewables account a negligible share of the energy mix (~1%); but a growing set of renewable projects to triple generation capacity.
- Increased flexibility on IPPs to accelerate power generation.

Fiber market



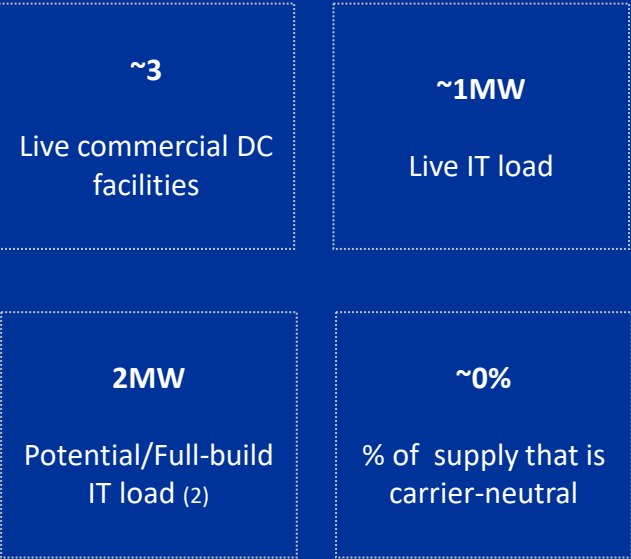
- Growing fiber base; “Projet de Couverture Nationale” fiber project underway, ~3,000km of terrestrial fiber connecting key towns.
- Ongoing Central African Backbone (CAB) project to expand Congo's fiber backbone reach, connecting to secondary towns and neighboring countries.
- Second submarine cable to (2Africa) to be operation, considerably expanding the country's bandwidth capability and overall fiber diversity.
- Submarine cables deployed across the Congo river to connect Brazzaville and Kinshasa.
- Increasingly diverse metro fiber market, with a growing base of independent fiber providers.

State of data center supply

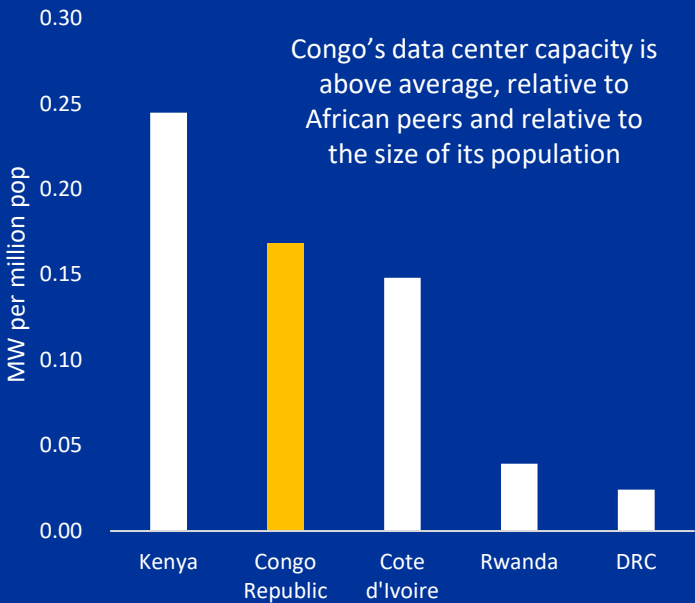
The Congolese market has doubled its available capacity over the past three years, hitting the 1MW mark

Congo data center supply – 2024E

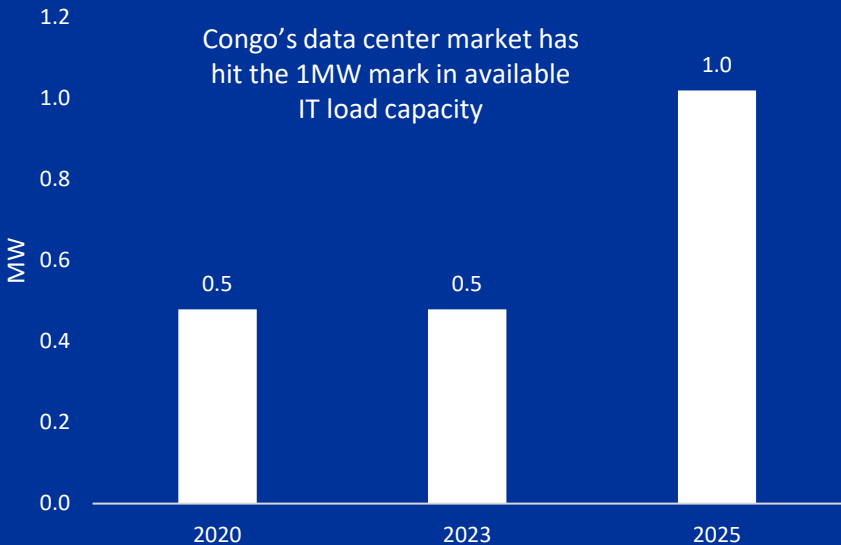
Sample market indicators (1)



Congo vs. Sub-Saharan Africa peers Critical IT load – MW per million population



Congo data center market – evolution of live supply Critical IT load - in MW



(1)Numbers are rounded up (2) Potential/Full-build load is facility capacity assuming that all phases of development have been completed. Additional CapEx would be needed to make the residual capacity operational.
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Key data center market players

Telcos, fiber infracos, and the government dominate the data center market in the Republic of Congo

Telcos & Fiber Infracos



Focused on mobility and fiber - colocation is an adjacent opportunity.

Government



New national data center to be initially managed by telecoms regulator

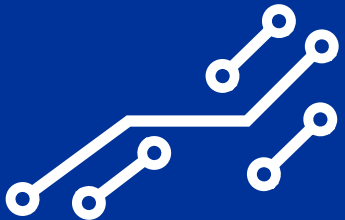
Telco and government focus



- Congo's entire commercial data center capacity is currently controlled by telecoms providers.
- The new upcoming facilities will be government-managed.
- Congo has yet to see the arrival of a pan-regional pure-play data center provider (like ADC, Paix, Raxio, etc.); this remains a possibility over the long term.



GLOSSARY & KEY DEFINITIONS



Key definitions

Data center	While there are a variety of definitions for data centers, this market review is focused on commercial facilities , that is, facilities that lease colocation white space and power capacity to third-party customers on open, commercial terms, and in exchange for a fee. Captive facilities (bank data centers, telco switch sites and similar) are excluded from this assessment. Estimates focus on facilities at Tier II standard and above, unless otherwise indicated. Where applicable, these estimates include cloud hyperscaler self-built facilities.
Live critical IT load	Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease.
Full build capacity	Data center facilities are typically built in phases; the full-build capacity is capacity assuming all potential phases of build have been completed and are live.
Capacity in construction	Facilities that have broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases.
Pipeline	Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land acquisition, power supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken.
Carrier-neutral	Facilities not specifically affiliated to a connectivity or cloud vendor, with capacity available to all third-party customers, on equal commercial terms, without explicit or implicit constraints or favoritism. This market review uses a loose definition for carrier-neutral, referring to facilities that are purely carrier-neutral, recognized by the market or effectively managed as such.

Glossary

Below are some of the key abbreviations used in this report

AI	Artificial Intelligence
ASN	Autonomous System Number
bn	billion
CAGR	Compound Annual Growth Rate
CapEx	Capital Expenditures
CDN	Content Delivery Network
Colo	Colocation
DC	Data Center
DIF	Digital Investment Facility
EAC	East African Community
EU	European Union
F	Forecast
FBB	Fixed Broadband
FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FX	Foreign Exchange
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
ICT	Information, Communications and Technology
ISP	Internet Service Provider
IPP	Independent Power Producer
IT	Information Technology

kW	Kilowatt
kWh	Kilowatt Hour
LLM	Large Language Models
m	million
MNC	Multinational Corporation
MNO	Mobile Network Operator
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue
MSP	Managed Service Provider
MW	Megawatts
NDC	National Data Center
OEM	Original Equipment Manufacturer
POP	Point of Presence
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SEZ	Special Economic Zone
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
USD	US dollar
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
YE	Year end



Learn more:

<https://d4dhub.eu/initiatives/data-governance-in-africa>

